

LUCKNOW | Coming Full Circle



STUDENTS IN A SWANKY CLASSROOM

SANJAY SONNAPAR

IN HER MOVE TO WIN BACK DALIT SUPPORT, MAYAWATI IS NOW LURING THE YOUTH BY PROVIDING THEM DREAM FACILITIES.

Sensing disillusionment among the backward classes for overplaying her Sarvasamaj slogan, Chief Minister Mayawati is once again focussing on her target segment—the Dalits. In a bid to woo young voters, she is now providing dream facilities to students at the Ambedkar hostel, part of Baba Sahib Bhimrao Ambedkar Samajik Parivartan Sthal in Lucknow. From palatial rooms to air-conditioned classrooms and facilities such as a digital library, the hostel has got it all. With promises of bringing the Dalits at par with the elite, Mayawati is again back to basics. *by Subhash Mishra*

KERALA | Medical Row

With doctors of government medical colleges on the warpath, Kerala's much-lauded public health system has taken a beating. The state Government recently hiked their monthly wages, with a maximum salary of Rs 1 lakh. But the hefty raise comes with a rider that doctor-professors cannot carry on with their lucrative private practice. Initially, a section of the Kerala Government Medical College Teachers' Association rejected the package and threatened to go on strike. However, a firm Government and public and media outcry against the "greedy doctors" saw them back out. Many doctors and members of the public have welcomed the ban on private practice.

by M.G. Radhakrishnan

NARENDRA MODI IS NOW INVITING STUDENTS TO HELP HIM IN BETTER GOVERNANCE.

AHMEDABAD | A New Chapter

In a yet another first from Chief Minister Narendra Modi, he launched the Gujarat Chief Ministers' Fellowship programme last week, inviting young graduates and post-graduates to work with the Government in their chosen areas and add to governance. Driven by his development charisma, everyday almost 150 students, nearly 25 per cent of them NRIs, send him numerous e-mails asking him to involve them in governance so they can share their knowledge and provide solutions, particularly in the health and education sector. "My vision is to involve the best minds in my endeavour to make this concept of good governance perfect. Our aim is to use their inputs for improving the human development index," says Modi. While the state chief secretary will shortlist such applicants, they will be interviewed by Modi. Recently, the programme drew appreciation from Planning Commission Deputy Chairman Montek Singh Ahluwalia when he learnt that no less than the chief minister was going to mentor it.

by Uday Mahurkar

